MASKINHALLEN · USER MANUAL · VERSION 1.6

KOLV

TECHNO CONDUCTOR · BUILDS THE TRACK WHILE IT PLAYS

KOLV writes a whole techno track in real time. The beat stumbles, mutates and grows for hours without repeating, and it always lands on the one.



VST3 · AU · LV2 · STANDALONE
MACOS · WINDOWS · LINUX

MASKINHALLEN

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01 WELCOME

KOLV doesn't play a loop. It writes a whole techno track in real time: kick, hats, clicks, percussion, bass and stabs, shaped into an arc with an intro, groove, tension, drop and release. The beat stumbles, mutates and grows for hours without repeating, and it always lands on the one.

All 235 sounds and 44 kits from BETONG are built in, so KOLV sounds right the moment you press play. Every label in KOLV can be shown in Swedish or English with the `SV | EN` button. This manual uses the English names, with the Swedish one in grey where it helps.

THE WINDOW



02 INSTALL

Unzip the file for your system. You get a folder called **KOLV**. Then run the installer for your system and restart your DAW (or rescan plug-ins). KOLV shows up as an instrument.

MACOS

1. Double-click `KOLV-macOS.zip` in Downloads.
2. Open Terminal and run:
   `bash ~/Downloads/KOLV/installera.command`
3. Quit your DAW completely and start it again.

VST3, AU and a standalone app. macOS 11 or newer, Intel or Apple Silicon. The installer copies the plug-ins and removes macOS's block on downloaded plug-ins.

WINDOWS

1. Right-click `KOLV-Windows.zip` and choose **Extract all**.
2. Open the `KOLV` folder and right-click `installera.bat` → **Run as administrator**.
3. If Windows says "Windows protected your PC": **More info** → **Run anyway**.

VST3 (in C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3) and a standalone .exe. 64-bit Windows 10 or 11.

LINUX

1. Unzip `KOLV-Linux.zip`.
2. Run `bash ~/Downloads/KOLV/installera-linux.sh`. It copies the plug-ins to `~/.vst3` and `~/.lv2`.
3. Rescan plug-ins in your DAW (Bitwig, Reaper, Ardour and others).

VST3 and LV2, 64-bit x86 Linux (built on Ubuntu 22.04).

> **SWEDISH OR ENGLISH**
> The machines have Swedish names on the panel. One click on `SV | EN` in the header switches labels, menus and tooltips to English. Your choice is remembered for every MASKINHALLEN machine.

03 UNLOCK WITH YOUR KEY

Your purchase comes with a licence key: four groups of four characters, like `XXXX-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX`. You find it in the Payhip email and on your receipt.

1. Open KOLV. Until it is unlocked, the window shows **UNLOCK KOLV**.
2. Paste the whole key in the field and press `UNLOCK`.
3. Done. You only need to do this once per computer: every MASKINHALLEN machine on the computer finds the key. A bundle key unlocks every machine.

The key is not case sensitive, and I/L and O/0 are treated as the same character, so a typo there does not matter. If it says the key does not work, check that the whole key was pasted. You can use your key on your own computers.

THE FREE DEMO

Every machine has a free demo with the same sound engine. Some presets and functions are locked, and the demo has its own name (KOLV DEMO), so it can sit next to the full version. Buying the full version is what unlocks everything; install it and paste your key.

UPDATES

Updates are free for life. Download the new zip from your Payhip receipt link and run the installer again. Your projects and your key are kept.

04 QUICK START: MUSIC IN 60 SECONDS

1. **Load KOLV on an instrument track** in your DAW (it's an instrument, not an effect). Or open the standalone app.
2. **Press play in your DAW.** KOLV follows your tempo and position to the sample. In the standalone app, press `PLAY` and set `TEMPO`.
3. **Press** `NEW IDEA` until something grabs you. Each press gives a new seed, style, kit and key.

4. **Like the style but not the pattern?** Press `SIMILAR`. Went too far? `◀` goes back, `▶` forward. KOLV remembers your last 64 ideas.

5. **Ride it live:** turn `CHAOS` for more mutation, switch off `AUTO` and ride `ENERGY` yourself, and hit `SPARK` for a surprise.

> **Only the kick and stab are playing?** That's the intro. KOLV brings tracks in as the energy rises, just like a DJ would. Wait a few bars, or switch off ENERGY `AUTO` and turn ENERGY above 60 %. See The arc & energy.

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05 THE SCREEN

HEADER

The KOLV logo (click it for the story of the Docklands boatyard), the current style and kit, the idea buttons, the phase you're in (INTRO, GROOVE ...), bar number, key, the energy meter and CPU.

THE ARC

The bar under the header shows the whole track: every section, how long it is and where you are. DENSITY at the right shows how many hits the current phrase is allowed.

SIX TRACKS

KICK, HAT, CLICK, PERC, BAS, STAB. Each has `LOCK`, a step grid (bright = playing now, dim = resting), `ECHO` send, `LVL`, the sound button, a dice, `FX`, `SHOW` and `M1-M4`.

THREE TABS

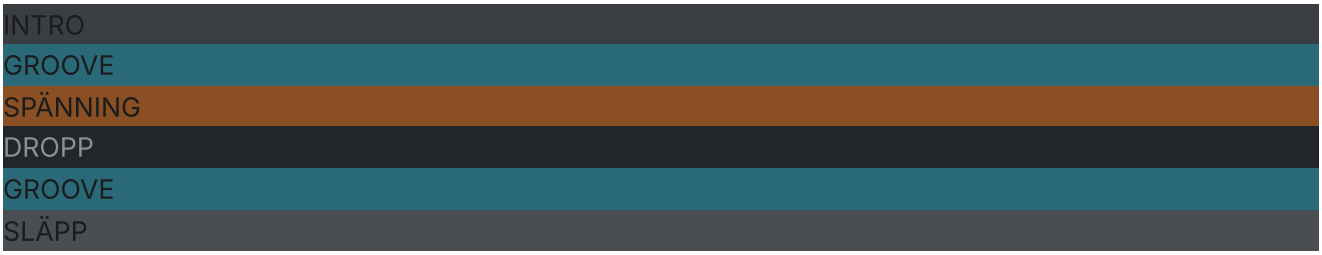
`CONDUCTOR` runs the track. `LANES` holds eight euclidean modulators. `MESS` *(STÖK)* has crush, skew and the dub echo.

A small number next to a track name, like `7/16`, means that track is running a different length from the others. That's polyrhythm, and it's on purpose.

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06 THE ARC & ENERGY

KOLV arranges like a DJ plays. Every track is an **arc** built from five kinds of sections:



SECTION	ENERGY	WHAT HAPPENS
INTRO	15 → 50 %	Starts with kick and stab, the rest come in one by one. Only in the first arc.
GROOVE	about 60 %	Everything plays, the energy breathes gently. The main body of the track.
SPÄNNING *tension*	60 → 98 %	Builds hard. Percussion always joins, filters open.
DROPP *drop*	34 %	4 or 8 bars without kick and bass. Then GROOVE slams back.
SLÄPP *release*	60 → 20 %	The track winds down.

Each track joins when the energy passes its threshold:

TRACK	PLAYS FROM ENERGY
STAB	always
KICK	12 % (silent in DROPP)
CLICK	20 %
HAT	28 %
BAS	36 % (silent in DROPP)
PERC	55 %, or always in SPÄNNING

ENERGY AUTO on: the arc drives the energy. **AUTO off:** the ENERGY knob drives it, live. That's the most powerful performance control in KOLV: pull it down to strip the track back to kick and stab, push it up to bring everything in.

07 CONDUCTOR TAB: EVERY CONTROL

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
`SEED` + dice	The track's DNA. Same seed and style always gives the same track, at the same bar. The dice gives a new seed.
`CHAOS` *KAOS*	How many and how big the mutations are per phrase, and how fast the timbre wanders. 20–40 % is hypnotic, 70 %+ is restless.
`ENERGY` + `AUTO`	See the arc. AUTO on: the arc decides. Off: you decide.
`GROOVE` *SVÄNG*	Swing on the odd 16ths. Never on the kick.
`PUMP`	Built-in sidechain: the kick pushes everything else down.
`VOLUME`	Master level with soft saturation.
`STYLE`	The rhythm grammar the conductor follows. AUTO lets the seed choose. See the 22 styles.

`KIT` + dice	Which BETONG kit plays. AUTO picks one that fits the style and changes it when the style drifts.
`PHRASE`	Bars between mutations: 4, 8, 16 or 32. One change per phrase is what makes it hypnotic.
`LENGTH`	Bars per arc: 64, 128, 192, 256 or 512.
`ROT`	Root key. Or play a key into KOLV from your MIDI keyboard and everything moves there.
`CHANNELS`	For MIDI OUT. See MIDI.
`ENDLESS`, `STYLE DRIFT`, `KEY DRIFT`	See ENDLESS mode.
`LOCK` per track	Freezes that track: no mutations, no timbre drift. Lock the kick and bass you love, let the rest evolve.
`LVL` / `ECHO` per track	Level (drag to zero to mute) and how much goes to the dub echo.

08 IDEAS: NEW IDEA, SIMILAR, SPARK

NEW IDEA *NY IDÉ*

A whole new track: new seed, style AUTO, kit AUTO, a new key, new lanes and sometimes a touch of skew or crush.

SIMILAR *LIKNANDE*

Keeps the style and kit that are playing, gives a new pattern. Perfect when the sound is right but the groove isn't.

SPARK *GNISTA*

One unexpected change while the track keeps going: a new sound on a track, a new lane, echo, a new kit, chaos, skew/crush or swing. The status line tells you what happened.

◂ ▸

Step back and forward through your last 64 ideas. Your knob tweaks are saved with each idea when you leave it.

09 SOUNDS & KITS

Each track plays a sound from the current BETONG kit: the kick, closed hat (open on accents), rim, two percs, and bass and stab tuned to the key. The stab has its own dub delay.

Click the **sound button** on a track (for example `HARDGROOVE 909 ▾`) to choose:

- **From the kit**: follow the kit (default).
- **KOLV's synth**: KOLV's own synth engines.
- **The old KOLV synth**: the original monophonic acid voice with ladder filter, accent and 303 slide. Ten recipes, from HYPNOS and ACID to DUB & EKO and HARDGROOVE. Best on BAS and STAB.
- **Every sound in the library**, sorted into Kicks, Hats and cymbals, Clap and snare, Perc, Bass, Stabs and chords, Textures, Leads, Voices, FX and Forge.
- **Favourites**, **MASKINHALLEN** and **Load VST3/AU...**: see the rack.

The **dice** next to the sound button gives a new sound of the same kind. The conductor's macros shape every sound: M1 is openness (how long it rings, follows the energy), M2 timbre, M3 drum pitch, M4 drive.

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10 THE 22 STYLES

A style is a rhythm grammar: a base pattern per track, which steps are allowed to fill in, polymeter lengths, swing, how late things may stumble, which tracks change most and which bass notes are allowed. The pattern drifts away from the base and is pulled back the further it goes. Things disappear and return. It is hypnosis, not drift. `AUTO` lets the seed choose.

STYLE	CHARACTER
`LESS IS MORE`	Air around every click, one stab per bar
`HYPNOS`	Rimshot cycles of 5 and 12, light shuffle, tracks cut out for a phrase and return
`SPASM`	Percussive: 16th hats with every fourth late, dense snare
`BARA GROOVE`	Just groove: only drums, bass and funk. Find the groove and stay
`LOOPVERKSTAD`	Loop workshop: offbeat open hat and ride, rolling toms, no swing
`DUBKANAL`	Dub channel: no swing, offbeat hat, clap on 2 and 4, syncopated stab in dotted delay
`SKEV SHUFFLE`	Skewed shuffle: the percussion plays melody with the bass, heavy shuffle
`FASFÖRSKJUTNING`	Phase shifting: loops of different lengths slide apart
`SVENSK LOOP`	Stockholm 90s: tight looped hats, 3-step perc, rolling octave bass
`INDUSTRI`	Hammering offbeat bass, dense metal clicks, 3-step perc
`SPARTANSK`	Spartan: almost only a kick and a bouncing sub
`DIMMA`	Fog: a steady kick under droning dub swells, almost nothing else
`BETONGDUB`	Concrete dub: soft kick, rolling swing, dub chords, hats that build
`HÅRD LOOP`	Hard loop: loop-driven industrial techno, hard offbeats, rolling toms
`SKIVSPELARE`	Turntable: the same record under two tone arms drifting out of phase

STYLE	CHARACTER
ACID MINIMAL	Rolling bassline with octave jumps, accents and resonance
TVÅNG	Compulsion: 3, 5 and 7-step loops that never meet, short rolls
PARANOIA	Hats that roll and stop dead, perc in nine steps, nothing gets to rest
SLÄPET	The drag: funk where everything comes late, heavy shuffle, the bass hangs behind
STAMP	Stomp: hard funk three against four, click and bass in threes over straight kicks
FEBER	Fever: rolls building up to every bar, hammering 16th hats, no mercy
SKRUV	Screw: hypnotic acid psychosis, the bass twists around the kick, perc in three against click in fourteen

The last six (TVÅNG to SKRUV) are the hard styles: the conductor can roll hats, clicks and perc (2–4 hits inside one step). Plus **LEARNED**: your own style, made by LEARN MIDI. No patterns are copied from any track.

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11 LANES TAB BANOR

Eight euclidean lanes that pull on the sound in their own rhythm, completely independent of the pattern. Different rates against each other give real polyrhythm, and this is where KOLV gets its "alive" feel.

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
TARGET	**Filter** (plus closes, minus opens a high-pass) · **Ton** (pitch jumps, zaps) · **Eko-kast** (throws the hit into the dub echo) · **Kross** · **Hacka** (chop) · **Stutter** (2–4 fast repeats of the track's last hit) · **M1–M4** (the track's macros, or knobs in a loaded VST) · **Rotera nästa** (each hit rotates the next lane's rhythm one step, so the lanes push each other) · **Av** (off)
TRACK	Which track it works on, or ALL.
BAR *TAKT*	The lane's own rate: 1/32, 1/16, 1/8, 1/4, 1/16T, 1/8T, 3/16, 5/16 or quintuplets.
STEPS / HITS / ROT	The euclidean rhythm, like 5 hits spread over 16 steps, rotated.
DEPTH / DECAY	How hard it pulls (minus flips it) and how long each pulse rings.

Each lane has its own dice. RANDOMIZE LANES builds a fresh set with 3–5 lanes running, following a recipe so it sounds like techno and not noise. Stutter and pitch jumps are also sent as MIDI.

12 MESS TAB STÖK

CRUSH *KROSS*

Lo-fi bits and sample rate on everything except the kick.

SKEW *SKEV*

Tape wobble, wow and flutter, on everything except the kick.

DUB ECHO

Tempo-synced ping-pong with TIME (1/16 to 5/16), FEEDBACK, TONE and LEVEL. Feed it with each track's ECHO knob, or throw single hits in with an Eko-kast lane.

13 THE RACK: PLAY YOUR OWN VSTS

Every track can play any VST3 or AU instead of a sample. Click the sound button › **Load VST3/AU...** and pick, say, BETONG for drums, ARMERING for bass and TURBIN for the stab. KOLV plays the plugin, and the pump and levels still apply. Pick a sound in the same menu to go back.

- `SHOW` opens the plugin's window.
- `M1–M4`: click, then turn a knob in the plugin. The conductor takes it over. M1 follows the energy (opens in tension, closes in the drop), M2–M4 wander slowly on prime-number cycles. KOLV also auto-links knobs with promising names (cutoff, resonance, decay, mix) when you load a plugin.
- `FX ▾` puts an effect after the track's sound, like FUKT on the bass, KULVERT on the perc or FRÄS on the hats. Works on samples and loaded plugins.
- **MASKINHALLEN** in the menus loads any installed sibling with one click. **Favourites** remembers your last twelve.
- **Nudge** (a little) or **randomize** (wildly) a plugin's knobs from the menu or the track's dice. Volume, mix and bypass are left alone, and there's an undo.
- Plugins, their settings and links are saved with your project. Watch **CPU** top right: on an older Mac two or three heavy plugins is usually the limit.

> **Heads up:** if a loaded plugin crashes, it takes KOLV (and maybe your DAW) with it. The safe alternative is MIDI OUT with CHANNELS set to ONE PER TRACK and the plugins on their own DAW tracks.

14 ENDLESS MODE: HOURS WITHOUT REPEATING

With `ENDLESS` *EVIGHET* on, the track never loops. When an arc ends, a new one is born from the seed and the arc number. Off: the arc loops from its first GROOVE.

- `STYLE DRIFT` (with STYLE on AUTO): the style crossfades into a neighbour, one track per phrase like a DJ mix. Kick first, bass last.
- `KEY DRIFT`: the key moves a fourth or fifth between arcs.
- **Prime cycles** of 7–73 bars turn timbre and swing. Together they repeat only after tens of thousands of bars.
- **Density budget:** each phrase has a cap on hits. If one track takes space, another must leave.
- **Anti-repetition:** if the exact same phrase was heard recently, it's forced onward.

Tested: two hours gives 94–96 % unique phrases and not a single repeated 32-bar block.

15 LEARN MIDI LÄR

Press `LEARN MIDI...` and pick one or more MIDI files: your own beats or bought MIDI packs. KOLV works out how often each step plays per track, which steps are ever used, swing, micro-timing, how much each track varies and which bass notes are used. The result is the style **LEARNED**, which the conductor then mutates and develops forever.

Drums are recognised on channel 10 or by General MIDI drum notes. Notes below E3 become bass, above become chords. The learned style is saved with your project.

16 LIKE, UNDO AND EXPORT

- `LIKE` *GILLA* pins what's playing right now. From the next bar, everything orbits around that pattern. Pins are saved with the project.
- `UNDO` removes the latest pin.
- **Rewind** your DAW: KOLV calculates exactly the same bar at the same place. Bar 40 always sounds the same for the same seed.
- `EXPORT MIDI...` saves 64–2048 bars as a MIDI file, one track per instrument, with tempo. Drag it into your DAW and finish the track by hand.

17 MIDI OUT & IN

`MIDI OUT` sends KOLV's notes onward so you can drive any instrument in your DAW. `CHANNELS`:

- **GM (drums 10)**: drums on channel 10, bass on 1, stab on 2.
- **ONE PER TRACK**: KICK 1, HAT 2, CLICK 3, PERC 4, BAS 5, STAB 6.

Routing the MIDI to other tracks is done in your DAW. **MIDI in:** play a key into KOLV and the whole track moves to that root (latched until you change ROT).

18 THE RULES KOLV PLAYS BY

THE KICK IS THE LAW

It's never mutated. It only goes quiet in the drop.

ONE CHANGE PER PHRASE

That's what makes it hypnotic instead of random.

TIMBRE OFTEN, NOTES RARELY

Timbre wanders every bar. The bass changes note at most every fourth phrase, and only within the minor scale.

THE BASS NEVER LANDS ON THE KICK

So the low end stays clean.

POLYRHYTHM

PERC can be 3, 5, 7, 9, 11 or 13 steps, CLICK 7, 10, 12 or 16, HAT 15 or 16.

EVERYTHING DRAGS, NOTHING RUSHES

Micro-timing is always late, so it still lands on the one.

19 RECIPES

ALL-NIGHT DJ TOOL

ENDLESS + STYLE DRIFT + KEY DRIFT on, STYLE AUTO, LENGTH 256, CHAOS 30 %. Press play and leave it.

LIVE PERFORMANCE

ENERGY AUTO off. Ride ENERGY for build-ups and breakdowns, LOCK the kick and bass, hit SPARK on the drop.

DEEP DUB

STYLE DUBKANAL or GAS, ECHO 30–50 % on STAB and PERC, an Eko-kast lane on CLICK at 3/16, SKEW 20 %.

HARD & INDUSTRIAL

STYLE INDUSTRI or BIRMINGHAM, PUMP 70 %, CRUSH 25 %, FUKT in the FX slot on BAS.

WRITE A TRACK, THEN FINISH IT

Find an idea, press LIKE on the best moment, EXPORT MIDI 256 bars and arrange it in your DAW.

KOLV AS THE BRAIN

Load BETONG on KICK–PERC and ARMERING on BAS through the rack, link M1–M4 to their filters, and let the conductor play your whole MASKINHALLEN setup.

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20 GROOVE TAB: DRAG, INERTIA AND EMPTY SPACE

The GROOVE tab (since 1.5) decides *when* every hit lands. Everything at zero sounds exactly like before.

`DRAG`	Per track, from −15 to +40 ms: before or after the grid.
`INERTIA` *TRÖGHET*	Hit after hit in a row comes later and later, like sliding on oil.
`ORBIT` *BANA*	The timing circles slowly over eight bars.
`SPACE` *LUFT*	Takes hits away but keeps the kick, the accents and the beats of the bar. The groove is built from what is not played.
`PERFECT OFF-TIME`	The same small timing error in the same place every bar, so the "mistake" becomes the groove.
`GROOVE ...` *GUNG*	Six ready feels: STRAIGHT, COLOGNE SCHOOL, MICRO FUNK, PERFECT OFF-TIME, DRAGSPEL and STUDIODUB.

The groove follows into the MIDI export.

21 STEPS, DENSITY AND ACCENTS

CONDITIONS

Steps can play only every other bar (1:2, 2:2), once in four bars (4:4), only in a fill or never in a fill. KOLV makes automatic fills and a snare roll before the drop. In the grid, conditional steps are drawn half filled and rolls as lines.

LENGTH PER TRACK

Each track can have its own length: AUTO, or 3 to 32 steps. A track with its own length stays there, the pattern repeats as it gets longer and the conductor leaves the length alone. Different lengths against each other give real polyrhythm.

STEP LOCKS

A step can have its own pitch, its own length or an alternative sound. The conductor mutates the locks along with the pattern.

DENSITY AND ACCENTS

`DENSITY` per track: left thins it out (the kick on the quarters stays), right fills the gaps with ghost hits. The accent selector pushes quarters, offbeats, every 3rd, every 5th, 3+3+2 or the last 16th on hat, click and perc.

SWAY AND TONE

Perc and click get notes from a dark scale, the phrase changes key, and hats and everything else sway like tape. `TONE` tunes each track from −24 to +12 semitones.

22 SOUND TOOLS

MY LIBRARY AND SIMILAR

Point KOLV at a folder of samples. It reads them in the background, listens to every sound (length, tail, timbre, bass, noise, pitch) and sorts each one to the right track. With `MY LIBRARY` on, empty tracks take your own sounds and NEW IDEA picks new ones. The `≈` button on a track finds the closest sound in timbre, built in or your own.

KICK WORKSHOP

In the sound menu on KICK and PERC: build a kick from `TOP`, `BOTTOM`, `SWEEP`, `LENGTH`, `CLICK` and `DIRT`, with a waveform view and `RANDOM`. The dice gives new recipes.

TRY AND MORPH

`TRY` makes a variant B of what is playing. A/B switches between them, ✓ keeps B, ✕ goes back. `MORPH` glides from A to B: knobs move smoothly, sounds change track by track and the pattern switches in the middle.

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23 THE DARKNESS STAGE AND OUTPUTS

Under the MESS tab sits the darkness stage. KOLV sounds hard and dark from the start (RUMBLE 30 %, PRESSURE 45 %, DARKNESS 35 %).

`RUMBLE` *MULLER*	The kick through a dark concrete room. Only the low end is kept, and it ducks for the kick.
`PRESSURE` *TRYCK*	Hard kick clipping, parallel compression and asymmetric saturation on the bus, and the master is pushed.
`DARKNESS` *MÖRKER*	Takes the treble off everything except the kick, from 20 kHz down to 2.2 kHz.

MULTI OUT

With `MULTI OUT` on, every track (KICK, HAT, CLICK, PERC, BAS, STAB) gets its own stereo output in the DAW. Off (the default): everything comes out of the main output. Some DAWs switch on all outputs by themselves; leave MULTI OUT off if you only want the main output.

THE COMPACT WINDOW (1.6)

The window is now 1260 × 640: the lanes sit tighter, the knobs show their value beside them and the name sits at the top of each column.

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24 TROUBLESHOOTING

KOLV does not show up	Quit the DAW completely and start it again, or rescan plug-ins. On Mac, run the installer again: it removes macOS's quarantine on the plug-in. On Windows, check that `KOLV.vst3` is in C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3.
macOS says the plug-in is damaged	That is macOS's block on downloaded files. Run `bash ~/Downloads/KOLV/installera.command` again.
Windows protected your PC	Click **More info** → **Run anyway**. The plug-ins are not signed with a paid certificate.

The key does not work	Paste the whole key, including the dashes. A key for one machine only unlocks that machine; a bundle key unlocks all.
No sound	Press play in the DAW: the machines follow the transport. Instruments go on an instrument track, effects on an audio track or bus.

Anything else? Ask through the store, and the person who built the machine answers.

MASKINHALLEN